

Fengzhi Zhu

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Research Interests

Financial Reporting, Conservatism, Disclosure, Gender, Textual Analysis

Education

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	Madrid, Spain
Ph.D. Candidate in Accounting	Sep 2019 – Aug 2023 (expected)
Supervisors: Juan Manuel García Lara, Beatriz García Osma	
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	Madrid, Spain
Research Master in Business and Finance	Sep 2017 – Jul 2019
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	Madrid, Spain
Bachelor in Finance and Accounting	Sep 2013 – Jul 2017
Temple University, Fox School of Business	Philadelphia, U.S.
Visiting Ph.D. student	Jan 2022 – May 2022
Supervisor: Basu Sudipta	
University of Wisconsin Madison	Madison, U.S.
Undergraduate international exchange student	Sep 2015 – May 2016

Working Papers

Firms' Disclosure Strategies and Users' Information Acquisition

I study how firms' disclosure strategies affect users' information acquisition. Firms can influence users' decisions to acquire information using two disclosure strategies: bundling or smoothing. Examining the filing timestamps and download logs of non-earnings 8-Ks from 2003 to 2017, I find that smoothing increases information acquisition, consistent with smoothing mitigating the negative consequences of disclosure overload. Bundling induces short-term increase but long-term decrease in information acquisition. Despite of firms' incentives to hide bad news through strategic disclosures, I find that strategic bad news disclosures are associated with higher information acquisition than non-strategic bad news disclosures. Furthermore, I document that the market reacts more positively to strategic disclosures with higher downloads, indicating that the effectiveness of disclosure strategies is influenced by users' information acquisition. Overall, these results suggest that strategic disclosures may benefit users by encouraging information acquisition.

Narrative Conservatism

with Juan Manuel García Lara and Beatriz García Osma

We define narrative conservatism as narratives reflecting bad news in a more news-consistent, timely and complete manner than good news. Using a sample of Form 8-K filings from 2004 to 2020, we find that narrative disclosure is conservative. Narrative tone of 8-Ks is more news-consistent, and 8-Ks are filed faster and contain more forward-looking statements in response to bad news than to good news. Our evidence suggests systematic differences in market reactions to 8-Ks filed by firms with different levels of narrative conservatism.

Working in
Progress

Shareholder Voting and Disclosure in M&As

with Duy Tan Do, Beatriz García Osma, Anna Toldrà-Simats

Missing narratives: An Analysis of Biases in Sample Selection and Variable Choice in Textual Analysis Research

with Andrea Bafundi, Beatriz García Osma and Encarna Guillamón-Saorín

Conference
Presentations
(*by coauthor)

Firms' Disclosure Strategies and Users' Information Acquisition

University of Bristol 2nd PhD conference, October 2022

BAFA - SWAG Doctoral Colloquium, September 2022

AAA Doctoral Colloquium, June 2022

Narrative Conservatism

EAA Doctoral Colloquium, May 2022

FARS Midyear Meeting, January 2022

XVI International Accounting Research Symposium, November 2021

Macquarie Business School, September 2021*

AAA Annual Meeting, August 2021

CAAA Annual Conference, June 2021

EAA Annual Meeting, May 2021

Porto University, May 2021*

PRICIT Doctoral Workshop, April 2021

Stockholm School of Economics Faculty Workshop, April 2021*

Alliance Manchester Business School, March 2021*

XX GRUDIS Conference & Doctoral Colloquium, January 2021*

EAA-VARS, December 2020*

IESEG School of Management, December 2020*

Queen Mary University of London, December 2020*

Shareholder Voting and Disclosure in M&As

29th Finance Forum, July 2022*

EAA 44th Annual Congress, May 2022*

KU Leuven, December 2021*

	Warwick Business School, December 2021* WHU - Otto Beisheim School of Management, December 2021* Bayes Business School, December 2021* CUNEF Universidad, November 2021* 1th PhD and Young Accounting Scholars Conference, October 2021* CAAA Craft Workshop, June 2021 HEC Paris, March 2021*	
	Missing narratives: An Analysis of Biases in Sample Selection and Variable Audit Analytics Symposium at EAA Annual Meeting, May 2021* Natural Language Processing in Financial Markets Worskhop, November 2018* Universitat Jaume I, November 2018* EAA Annual Meeting, May 2018*	
Conference & Workshop Participations	2022: BAFA - SWAG Annual Conference, EAA Annual Congress (Bergen) 2021: EAA Annual Congress (Bergen), CAR Virtual Conference, EAR Virtual Conference, UT-Austin Virtual PhD Student Symposium, Limberg Institute Virtual Python Course 2020: UT-Austin Virtual PhD Student Symposium, Statistical Programming and Open Science Methods (Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin) 2019: International Research Symposium for Accounting Academics (Madrid) 2018: International Research Symposium for Accounting Academics (Madrid)	
Service	2021 and 2020 European Accounting Review Virtual Annual Conference Member of the Organizing Committee 2019 27th Finance Forum and AEFIN Annual Meeting Conference volunteer Ad hoc reviewer: <i>Accounting and Business Research, Spanish Journal of Finance and Accounting</i>	
Honors & Scholarships	European Accounting Association 2021 CAAA Annual Conference Grant Universidad Carlos III de Madrid Movilidad 2022 PPI Investigadoras/es en Formación Predoctoral Doctoral and Master Training Scholarship Undergraduate Exchange Program Grant	2020 2022 2017-2023 2015
Academic Associations	European Accounting Association Canadian Academic Accounting Association American Accounting Association Accounting and Economics Society	Nov 2020 – Present Jan 2021 – Present July 2021 – Present Jun 2022 – Present

Teaching	Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	
	13174: Financial Accounting (Undergraduate, 3.2/5)	Fall 2021
	17622: Principles of Accounting (Undergraduate, 4.3/5)	Spring 2021
	13157: Introduction to Accounting (Undergraduate, 4.0/5)	Spring 2020
	13157: Introducción a la Contabilidad (Undergraduate, 2.5/5)	Spring 2019
Work Experience	Procter & Gamble	Madrid, Spain
	Financial Data Analyst Intern	Jan 2017 – Aug 2017
Skills	Programming	
	Python, Stata, R, LaTeX, Git, Microsoft Office Suite, Linux	
	Languages	
	Mandarin (native), English (bilingual), Spanish (proficient), Cantonese (intermediate)	
Reference	Beatriz García Osma	Juan Manuel García Lara
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